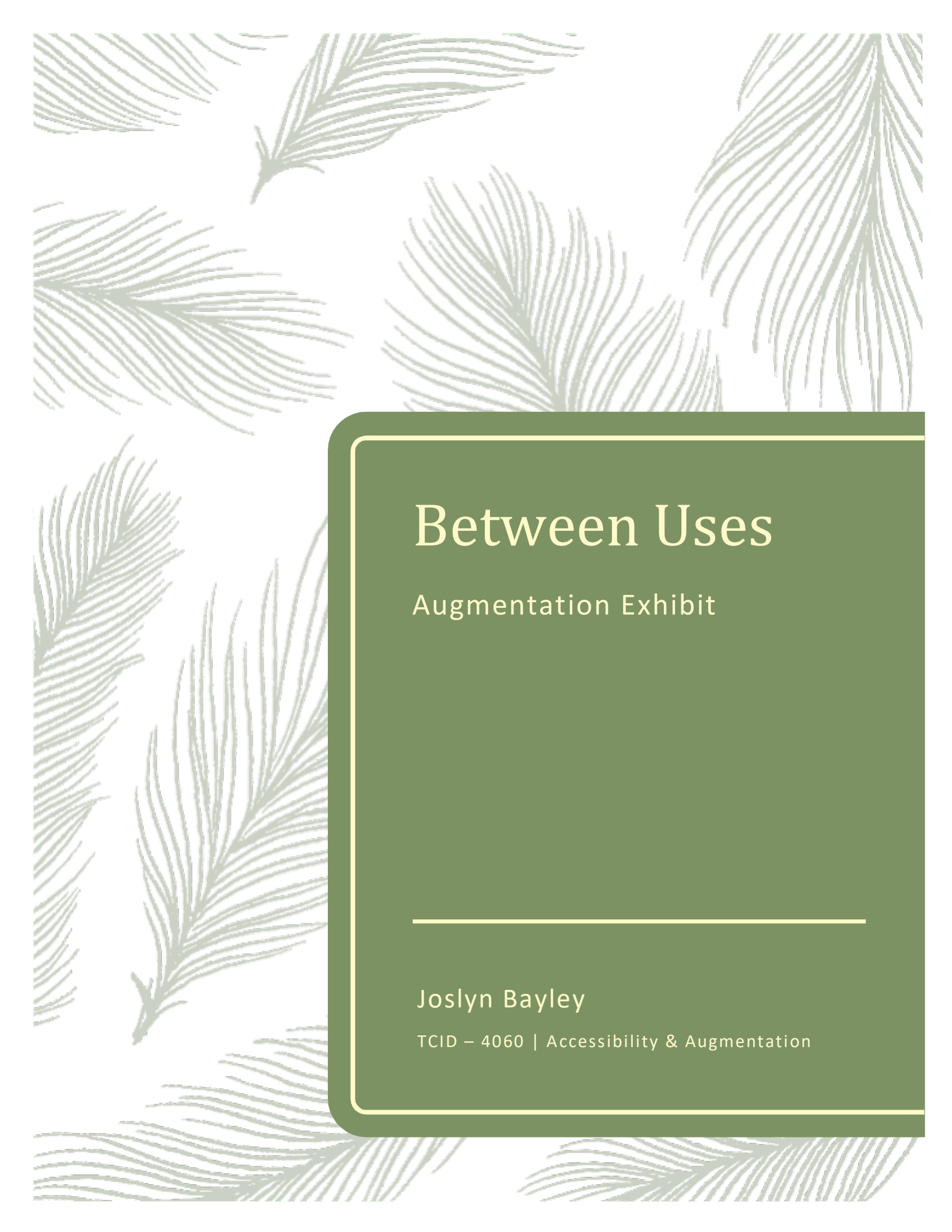




Between Uses

Augmentation Exhibit

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TCID – 4060 | Accessibility & Augmentation

Table of Contents

Working Concept	2
Exhibit Direction	3
Short Exhibit Label	5
What It Augments	5
Who It Is For	5
How It Works.....	6
Process & Critical Making	6
Accessibility, Usability, & User Experience	7
Why It Matters	7
Prototype Media / Exhibit Features	8

Working Concept

Most glasses holders seem designed around storage, not the constant switching between wearing glasses and taking them off throughout the day. This project started after I saw a video of an older woman getting visibly irritated trying to manage her glasses while baking. She kept setting them down, moving them somewhere else, forgetting where they went, pushing them onto her head, taking them back off, and repeating the same cycle every few minutes. None of it was dramatic on its own, but the repetition started feeling exhausting pretty quickly.

After that, I started looking at existing glasses holders and realized most of them either looked overly decorative, strangely clinical, bulky, or uncomfortable to wear in public. I love whimsical accessories and wanted more freedom to change up my everyday look without replacing the glasses themselves every time I wanted something different. Frames are expensive, so once you wear the same pair every day, they start becoming part of your appearance whether you intended that or not.

The current direction explores a modular wearable system that can be used three different ways:

- as a full glasses chain
- as smaller charms attached directly to the frames
- as a standalone necklace when the glasses are not attached

A lot of the project grew out of wanting those three configurations to move naturally between accessibility and appearance instead of treating them like separate goals.

Exhibit Direction



I have ordered three stands (below) to test out what will work best with the glasses. They arrive Friday, however. I will discuss this with you on Wednesday. For the time being, enjoy the photoshoot with Chorizo the Elephant.





Short Description

Between Uses is a modular wearable glasses system that can be worn three different ways: 1) as a full glasses chain, 2) as smaller frame charms, or 3) as a necklace when the glasses are not attached. The project focuses on the repeated handling surrounding glasses throughout the day, including removing them, repositioning them, setting them down temporarily, and searching for them again. Magnetic attachment points allow the system to shift between configurations while keeping the glasses nearby and easier to manage during everyday movement and task switching.

What It Augments

The project focuses on the constant handling surrounding glasses instead of vision itself. Putting glasses on and taking them off sounds small until it starts happening all day long: reading something nearby, walking outside, checking a phone, cooking, driving, sitting at a desk for five minutes before getting back up again. The glasses keep moving. Most people stop noticing how often they manage them until the routine gets annoying enough to interrupt everything else around it.

A lot of the project ended up centering on the moments between wearing the glasses and needing them again. Setting them down somewhere random. Forgetting where they went thirty seconds later. Hooking them onto a shirt collar. Dropping them while multitasking. Taking them off just long enough to do something nearby, then immediately needing them again. The repetition became more interesting than the glasses themselves.

Who It Is For

The design mainly considers:

- older adults
- people with limited mobility or grip strength
- users who repeatedly misplace their glasses
- people constantly switching between glasses and non-glasses tasks
- users who dislike bulky, clinical, or awkward-looking accessibility products

A lot of existing glasses holders feel visually separated from normal clothing and everyday movement. I kept thinking about how quickly accessibility objects start looking medical, decorative, or strangely overdesigned once they become visible accessories. Part of the project

became figuring out how to make something functional without making the user feel like they are wearing a workaround.

How It Works

The current direction uses a lightweight wearable attachment system that keeps the glasses nearby without forcing them into one fixed position. I kept thinking about how often people temporarily hang glasses on a shirt collar, shove them into a pocket for two minutes, or balance them somewhere random while doing something else. The prototype tries to remove some of that constant searching and repositioning without turning the glasses into another complicated accessory people have to manage carefully.

Right now the attachment system is still changing quite a bit. The main direction includes magnetic connection points, modular attachments, and different positioning options depending on how someone wants to wear them that day. The same pieces can shift between a full chain, smaller frame charms, or a necklace when the glasses are not attached. I do not want the glasses permanently attached to the person. They still need to move naturally between active use, temporary storage, and everyday movement without feeling restrictive or awkward.

Process & Critical Making

The project changed after I started noticing how much of wearing glasses has nothing to do with vision and everything to do with constantly handling them. At first, I mostly just wanted to make something less ugly than the glasses holders already on the market. I love whimsical accessories and wanted more freedom to change up my everyday look without needing to buy entirely different frames every time I wanted something new. Glasses are expensive, so once you wear the same pair every day, they start becoming part of your appearance whether you intended that or not.

That pushed the project toward modularity pretty quickly. The current direction can be worn three different ways — as a full glasses chain, as smaller charms attached directly to the frames, or as a necklace when the glasses are not attached. I did not expect accessibility and aesthetics to overlap this much when I started working on it. The project kept circling back to interruption. Taking glasses off for two minutes. Forgetting where they went. Balancing them on a shirt collar. Dropping them while doing something else. Repeating the same small routine over and over.

A lot of existing holders quietly assume people can reach comfortably, grip small objects easily, reposition glasses with one hand, and remember where they left them without much effort. Once any of that starts becoming harder, the interruptions pile up fast. The making process also

turned into way more trial and error than I expected. Tiny placement decisions started changing everything. A magnet slightly too high changes the balance completely. Stronger attachment points make the glasses annoying to remove quickly. Weaker ones make them feel unstable. Once movement and body position entered the process, the object stopped feeling theoretical pretty fast.

Accessibility, Usability, & User Experience

Nothing about the problem is especially dramatic on its own. It is the accumulation that gets irritating. Losing glasses once is whatever. Repeating the same cycle all day starts becoming exhausting pretty quickly: setting them down somewhere random, forgetting where they went thirty seconds later, knocking them onto the floor, balancing them on clothing, or stopping in the middle of another task just to deal with them again.

The design mainly tries to reduce:

- repeated searching
- unnecessary reaching
- dependence on nearby tables or surfaces
- dropping or damaging glasses
- constant interruption during task switching

The biggest tradeoff right now is simplicity versus stability. A stronger attachment keeps the glasses secure, but it can also make them annoying to remove quickly when moving between tasks. Lighter attachments feel better during normal wear, though they also shift around more easily. I also kept running into the visual side of accessibility objects while working on it. Something can function perfectly and still make people avoid wearing it if it feels too medical, too bulky, or too visually disconnected from normal clothing.

Why It Matters

A lot of this project came from how irritating glasses become once they stop staying where you thought you left them. Taking them off for a minute turns into searching for them again ten minutes later. Then the same thing happens again an hour after that. The actual object is small, but the repetition around it starts eating into everything else you are doing.

Working on the prototype also made a lot of assumptions around ordinary objects feel way more obvious. Most glasses workflows assume someone can reach comfortably, grip small objects easily, remember placement, bend down without trouble, and recover dropped items without much effort. Once any of those actions becomes frustrating, the whole routine starts feeling heavier than it should.

The future behind the project is honestly pretty ordinary. I am not trying to imagine smart glasses, AI overlays, or anything hyper-technological. I just think accessibility objects should feel more integrated into normal movement and everyday appearance instead of immediately turning into something clinical, awkward, or visually separate from everything else someone wears.